Emulsification of Fats & Oils

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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Written by: Lára Marie McIvor
Reviewed by: Lucy Kirkham
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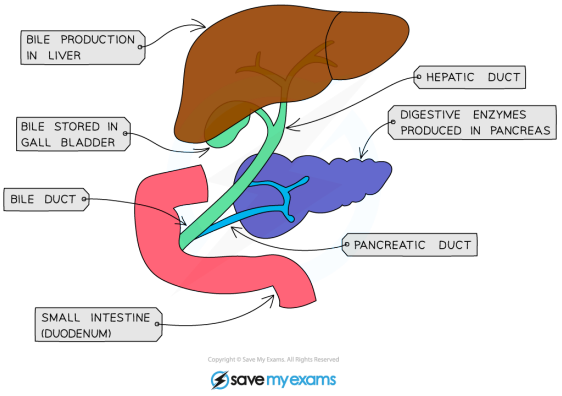
Emulsification of Fats & Oils: Extended

Extended Tier Only

- Cells in the liver produce bile which is then stored in the **gallbladder**



Bile production and secretion

Bile has two main roles:

- It is **alkaline** to **neutralise the hydrochloric acid** which comes from the stomach
- The enzymes in the small intestine have a higher (more alkaline) optimum pH than those in the stomach
- It **breaks down large drops of fat into smaller ones**. This is known as **emulsification**. The larger surface area allows lipase to chemically break down the lipid into glycerol and fatty acids faster

Help me understand

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Emulsification is the equivalent of tearing a large piece of paper into smaller pieces of paper.This is an example of **mechanical digestion**, not chemical digestion – breaking something into smaller pieces does not break bonds or

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